AI Prompt Cheat Sheets for TikTok/Reel Content Creation

Creating engaging short-form video content (TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts) can be supercharged with AI tools. Below are comprehensive **cheat sheets** with prompt examples and best practices for: **(1)** using ChatGPT to generate story ideas, scripts, and visual concepts, **(2)** crafting image generation prompts with tools like Stable Diffusion, ChatGPT's image creator (DALL·E 3) & Sora (text-to-video), Midjourney, and Leonardo AI, and **(3)** guiding **movement** and camera dynamics in AI-generated videos. Each section provides easy copy-paste prompt templates, parameters, and tips to maximize results. Let's dive in!

1. ChatGPT Storytelling Prompts (Ideas, Scripts & Visual Planning)

ChatGPT (powered by GPT-4) is a powerful creative partner for brainstorming story ideas, writing scripts, and even planning visuals. The key is **prompt engineering** – phrasing your requests clearly and specifically. Remember: **Good prompts = good** results. Here's how to harness ChatGPT for compelling short-video stories:

- **Set the Context and Role:** Begin by telling ChatGPT who it is or what role to assume. This provides context for style and expertise. For example: "*You are an expert viral video scriptwriter*" or "*Act as a seasoned TikTok content strategist*". This technique often yields more tailored, high-quality response.

- **Be Specific with Instructions:** Clearly state what you want (tone, format, length, style, audience, etc.). Vague prompts give generic outputs, while precise prompts unlock relevant, sharp content. Include details like the video genre, target audience, desired emotion, or outcome. *For instance: "Give me 5 short video story ideas (15 seconds each) about a **fitness challenge** for a **teen audience** in an **upbeat, motivational** tone."* By specifying audience and tone, you guide ChatGPT's style.

- **Structure Your Prompt & Output:** If you need a certain format (script, list of shots, etc.), say so. You can even request output in bullet points, a numbered list, or specific sections. For example: "*Outline a 3-act structure for a 30-second comedy sketch, with a hook, a conflict, and a resolution – provide it as a bulleted list.*" This ensures the response is organized as needed. Always mention the desired format or length (e.g. "*a 100-word script*" or "*10-second intro only*").

- **Include Tone and Style Cues:** Clearly indicate the tone, style, or perspective. ChatGPT can mimic styles if asked – e.g. "*in a playful, Gen-Z slang style*" or "*in the suspenseful tone of a thriller*". Defining the tone yields output that aligns with the vibe you want. You can even ask it to emulate a certain creator's style or a specific format (like "storytime voiceover" or "fast-cut vlog style").

- **Iterate and Refine:** Don't cram too many demands in one prompt. A complex request with conflicting details can confuse the AI. Instead, use a step-by-step approach: first ask for ideas, then drill down. For example, you might first prompt "*Pitch a few creative horror story ideas for a 60-second Reel*". After ChatGPT gives ideas, you can say "*Great, now script idea #2 in a **first-person narrative** style with a twist ending.*" Breaking the workflow into smaller tasks often yields better results. ChatGPT remembers context in a conversation, so you can progressively refine the content.

- **Use Constraints for Creativity:** You can set specific constraints to spark creative responses. e.g. "*Give a one-sentence plot summary for a travel Reel **without** using the word 'travel'.*" or "*Write a script under 75 words, with each sentence on a new line.*" Constraints force unique output and ChatGPT will respect the rules if clearly stated.